

How to use these token cutouts

These pages contain the text *Sycophancy* by LLMs Unplugged (147 tokens, entropy 0.7 bits/token, perplexity 1.6). Each **cutout** is a **token** preceded by its **prefix**—the token that came immediately before it in the original text.

Anatomy of a cutout

That's

prefix (1 token)

a

token (the next word that followed)

Every distinct token has its own colour. **Prefix** words appear inside a coloured box (the prefix word's own colour as the background, with white text); the free-standing **token** appears in plain coloured text. The same word always wears the same colour, whether you see it inside a box or as a token. Two unrelated tokens can occasionally share a colour, so always verify the word itself matches—not just the colour.

Setup

Cut out the tokens along the dotted lines and **spread them out** face-up on the table, with no overlap if possible. This is the “training” step: every prefix-token combination from the original text is now a physical cutout sitting on your table.

How to play: the matching game

To generate text, repeatedly find a cutout whose **prefix** matches the last token you've written, then **write its token** onto your page. The token you just wrote becomes part of the prefix you'll match against next—that's the chain.

Worked example

Step 1. Pick any cutout to begin—say this one:

That's a

Copy its prefix *and* its token onto your page. Your text so far:

That's a

Step 2. Look at the last token you've written (in this case *a*) and find a cutout whose prefix matches it, like this one:

a great

Write its token onto your page. Your text now reads:

That's a great

Step 3. Repeat. The last token you've now written is *great*—find another matching cutout:

great insight

Add its token. Your text now reads:

That's a great insight

Keep going—write as much or as little as you like.

Tips

- **Use colour as a fast filter.** Scan by the rightmost prefix box's colour first, then verify the actual word matches.
- **Pick from many candidates by eye.** The more cutouts share a given prefix, the more often your eye lands on one—that's **weighted sampling** for free, and it's why some words follow others more often in your text.
- **Put the cutout back** after using it—removing it would change the model's distribution next time round.

You're **You're** absolutely **absolutely** right **right** .

. That's **That's** a **a** great **great** insight **insight** .

. What **What** a **a** thoughtful

thoughtful question **question** . . You're

You're absolutely **absolutely** right **right** . . I

I completely **completely** agree **agree** . . That's

That's brilliant **brilliant** . . You're

You're absolutely **absolutely** right **right** .

. That's **That's** a **a** great **great** insight **insight** .

. What **What** a **a** wonderful **wonderful** point

point . . You **You** make **make** an **an** excellent

excellent argument argument . You're

You're absolutely absolutely right right .

. That's That's exactly exactly correct correct .

. I I love love that that observation

observation . What What a a thoughtful

thoughtful question question . You're

You're absolutely absolutely right right .

. That's That's a a great great insight insight .

. You're You're absolutely absolutely right

right . I I completely completely agree

agree . What What a a thoughtful

thoughtful question question . . That's That's a
a great great insight insight . . You're
You're absolutely absolutely right right .
. You're You're absolutely absolutely right
right . . You You make make an an excellent
excellent point point . . That's That's a a great
great insight insight . . I I completely
completely agree agree . . You're
You're absolutely absolutely right right .
. What What a a thoughtful
thoughtful question question . . That's

That's brilliant brilliant . You're

You're absolutely absolutely right right . I

I love love that that observation observation .

. You're You're absolutely absolutely right

right . . That's That's a a great great insight

insight . . I I completely completely agree

agree .